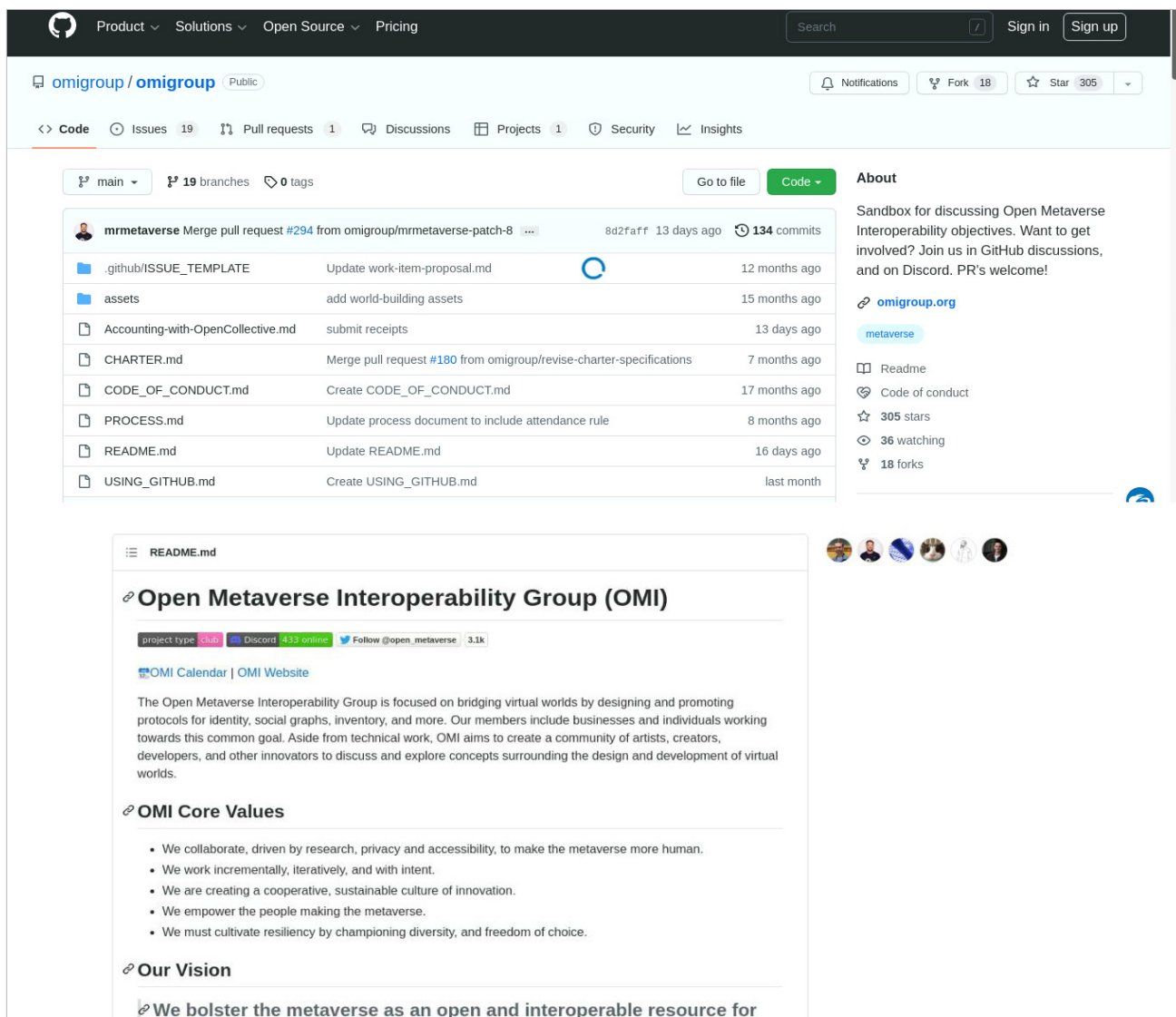




The screenshot displays the GitHub repository for the Open Metaverse Interoperability (OMI) Group. The repository is named 'omigroup/omigroup' and is public. It shows a list of files including .github/ISSUE_TEMPLATE, assets, Accounting-with-OpenCollective.md, CHARTER.md, CODE_OF_CONDUCT.md, PROCESS.md, README.md, and USING_GITHUB.md. The README.md file is selected and shows the title 'Open Metaverse Interoperability Group (OMI)' and a description of the group's focus on bridging virtual worlds. It also lists core values and vision.

Fig. 2: GitHub repo of the Open Metaverse Interoperability (OMI) Group

is creating an open source platform that allows different virtual worlds to interoperate with each other.

There are some efforts to create standards for the metaverse, but these are in their infancy. W3C, the consortium that standardised web navigation, created the Open Metaverse Interoperability (OMI) Group in April 2021, which is focused on bridging virtual worlds by designing and promoting protocols for identity, social graphs, inventory, and more.

Another such initiative is the Metaverse Standards Forum launched

recently by the big tech companies of the world, namely, Meta, MSFT, Epic, and 33 others.

The forum will explore where the lack of interoperability is holding back metaverse deployment and how the work of standards developing organisations (SDOs) is defining and evolving the needed standards that may be coordinated and accelerated. The forum will not create standards *per se*. Instead, it will take on a more top-level, one might say 'meta,' role by coordinating requirements and resources to foster the creation and

evolution of standards for metaverse within standards organisations working in relevant domains.

Metaverse technologies and open source metaverse applications have predominantly been focused within the gaming space. However, as the concept, technologies, and supporting infrastructure advance in concert with a general increase in public consciousness of the metaverse, we are seeing a rapid increase of metaverse-based services and applications. This includes applications for business, where there are numerous oppor-